



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Carmichael Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://carmichaelclassical.com>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Carmichael Classical Christian School (Jamestown, ND 58402) exhibits a classical orientation, anchored in Christian formation and partnership with families. Public materials show explicit religious framing (Christian mission, love of God) and a commitment to classical-curriculum providers (Memoria Press via CLSA) and to membership in classical associations (ACCS). There is clear planning for a K–12 institution with a staged launch (fall 2026 in Jamestown) and a small-family, church-linked start-up model (seven families currently meeting in a local church; growing intent to reach ~80 students with 14 staff). However, the site provides limited detail on specific classical pedagogy (e.g., Great Books, Socratic seminars, or explicit development of grammar-logic-rhetoric in the literature), and it lacks explicit statements about certain hallmark practices (e.g., liturgical/communal practices, a robust "living curriculum" portrait of teachers, or concrete parent-education programs). Taken together, these factors place CCCS in the "Somewhat Classical" range overall, with strong religious formation and community-anchored support but incomplete articulation of some core classical elements in public-facing materials.

- Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Main strengths: explicit Christian formation; parent partnership; utilization of established classical curricula (Memoria Press) and associations (ACCS, CLSA); clear formation-oriented aim.
- Gaps to move toward CLASSICAL: explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing; explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades; liturgical/community practices; explicit portrait of teachers as the living curriculum; documented parent-education initiatives.

Evidence sources include CCCS public materials describing mission, governance, curriculum partnerships, and growth plans, as well as the knowledge-base rubric and keyword framework for classical education. See citations for specific claims below.

- Evidence: Our Mission explicitly centers on loving God and partnering with parents.
- Evidence: The school publicly states it uses Memoria Press curriculum supplied via CLSA and plans CLSA accreditation, with a launch plan for K–12 in Jamestown by 2026, and a current structure of seven homeschooling families.
- Evidence: The school is a member of ACCS and CLSA, indicating alignment with classical-education networks.
- Evidence: The mission and outreach materials emphasize partnership with parents and a community-based model (home-school families meeting at a church).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence



- The public materials explicitly frame the school as Carmichael Classical Christian School and state the mission centers on training students to love God, indicating a theologically oriented orientation.
- The use of “Christian” in the school’s name and affiliations implies a theological/integrative approach to education (though direct references to liturgical practices or theological curricula are not elaborated in the public pages).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christian worldview (implied by the Christian school identity), theology-related orientation (theology, sacred tradition appear in the rubric as possible indicators; explicit terms like “Theology” are not spelled out in quotes on the site, but the mission is clearly theocentric).
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.
- Why this rating
- There is a clear religious/theological frame (Christian formation) guiding the mission, but public materials do not provide explicit liturgical practices, communal worship routines, or a formal theology curriculum. The alignment with positive theological indicators is present but not richly documented in the site copy. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for this dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission centers on formation around love of God and partnership with parents, signaling formation and virtue-oriented aims rather than purely information-driven outcomes.
- Growth plans emphasize forming a K–12 school community with a deliberate, long-term goal (80 students, 14 staff in year one) rather than solely job-prep metrics.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue-related language (implied by formation toward moral ends; explicit mentions of “virtue” or “wisdom” are not present in the public copy, but formation and Christian formation are present).
- Negative keywords present: None explicit.
- Why this rating
- The focus on formation (instead of job prep) is implied by the mission and the classical-context affiliations, but explicit articulation of virtue/wisdom as real aims (and the Truth-Goodness-Beauty triad) is not stated in the public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school uses Memoria Press curriculum through CLSA, indicating a classical curricular backbone.
- The school intends to function as a K–12 program with classical affiliation, but public materials do not spell out explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or the practice of the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as curriculum pillars.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Memoria Press (classical publisher), CLSA (classical curriculum network) (explicit in the public materials). These map to a classical curricular orientation.
- Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit liberal-arts pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric) references is notable.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is anchored in classical providers, which signals a classical orientation, but the lack of explicit statements about Great Books, virtues of the liberal arts, or direct articulation of the full classical curriculum framework puts it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in this rubric.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials emphasize a classical identity (K–12, Memoria Press, CLSA) and a homeschooling co-op origin, with anticipated upper-grade structures typical of classical education. However, there is no explicit description of Socratic seminars, dialectic methods, or rhetoric-based pedagogy on the site copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: “classical education” framing; presence of “lower/upper grade” sequencing is typical of classical models, though explicit forms (Socratic discussion, seminars) are not described in the site copy.
- Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit Socratic dialogues, seminars, or rhetoric-focused teaching methods in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The institution aligns with a classical pedagogy in identity and providers but does not publicly detail the key pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic inquiry, memorization, or rhetoric training). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is no public, explicit statement about faculty as “living curriculum,” model teachers, or a defined teacher portrait; the materials mostly describe organizational structure, mission, and curriculum providers rather than faculty roles or profiles.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords typically associated with the faculty dimension (e.g., “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” “mentor”) do not appear in the public-facing materials.
- Negative keywords: Absence of explicit faculty portraits, teacher-role descriptions, or a “living curriculum” framing.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit statements about faculty as living curriculum, or a teacher-portrait framework, the category cannot be rated as Classical on evidence; at best it remains underdeveloped in public materials, yielding NOT CLASSICAL in published description for this dimension.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission explicitly emphasizes partnering with parents in their children's education, indicating a strong parental-involvement orientation and a sense of parents as co-teachers.
- The school's origin as a seven-family homeschool/classical group living in a church context demonstrates a community-driven model with parents deeply engaged in classical education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnering with parents, co-teachers, community-based education, parent involvement.
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials for this category.
- Why this rating
- The explicit emphasis on parent-partnership and a church-based, parent-driven, community-centered model aligns strongly with the Parents & Community dimension of classical education.

Aggregate assessment - Relative weights across the six categories place CCCS in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall. Element 6 is CLASSICAL, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL, and Categories 1–4 are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate tilt is toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL because the strongest, most explicit elements are in religious formation and parent-community alignment, with explicit classical pedagogy and faculty portraits less documented publicly.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit language and documentation of

liturgical or communal practices (e.g., morning prayers, chapel schedules, sacred music) and a formal articulation of theology integrated across disciplines to transition toward CLASSICAL.

- For Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Articulate a clear, public statement about the cultivation of virtue and wisdom (truth, goodness, beauty) as real goods in the curriculum, with measurable outcomes or devotional practices tied to formation (to move toward CLASSICAL).
- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly list Great Books/Great Conversation commitments (even if via Memoria Press materials), and spell out how liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) are sequenced and integrated across K–12. Include examples of canonical readings and how Wonder is cultivated in the curriculum.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Describe explicit pedagogy practices such as Socratic discussions in upper grades, seminars, and opportunities for student rhetoric and oration; publish a pedagogy map showing how grammar, logic, and rhetoric are operationalized in classroom practice.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a living-curriculum profile of teachers, including expectations, mentorship roles, and a teacher portrait that illustrates how faculty model virtue, knowledge, and skill; provide examples of faculty involvement in shaping curriculum and student formation.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand on parent-education initiatives (book studies, parent evenings, community lectures) and demonstrate more opportunities for visits, volunteering, and deeper co-teaching roles on campus; publish a formal “parents as co-teachers” framework with examples.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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